

FREE PATTERN

Free Crochet Scrunchie Pattern for Beginners

A simple crochet-covered tube around a hair elastic — one of the fastest projects on the site.

Updated 2026 • US terms • Makes 3, standard adult size



This scrunchie is a simple tube of half double crochet worked directly around a hair elastic, then closed with a seam. It's a genuinely fast project — a great way to use up small amounts of leftover yarn from bigger patterns.

MATERIALS

- Small amount of worsted-weight yarn (about 10–15 yards per scrunchie)
- 5.0mm (US size H) crochet hook
- 1 standard hair elastic per scrunchie (1/4in / 6mm)
- Scissors
- Yarn needle, for weaving in ends

ABBREVIATIONS (US TERMS)

ABBR.

MEANS

ch	Chain
hdc	Half double crochet
st(s)	Stitch(es)

See our [abbreviations glossary](#) for the full list including UK terms.



Crochet hook with yarn for a scrunchie

GAUGE

Exact gauge isn't critical here — the goal is a snug, evenly covered tube around the elastic rather than a precise measurement.

NOTES

- Written in US terms, worked directly onto the elastic in a continuous tube.
- Makes one scrunchie; repeat 2 more times for a set of three.
- This is a good project for using up small leftover amounts of yarn from other patterns.

Pattern (make 3)

ROUND 1

Leaving a 4in / 10cm tail, make a slip knot and insert the hook through the centre of the hair elastic. Chain 1, then work hdc stitches directly over the elastic, covering it completely as you go around. Continue until the entire elastic is covered. *(around 40–50 sts, depending on elastic size)*

JOINING

Once the elastic is fully covered, slip stitch into the first hdc of the round to join and close the tube.

FINISHING

Fasten off, leaving a 4in / 10cm tail. Weave both tails through several stitches to secure, then trim.

Frequently asked questions

What elastic works best for a crochet scrunchie?

A standard 1/4 inch (6mm) braided hair elastic, tied into a loop, works well and is easy to find at any craft or fabric store.

How much yarn do I need for a crochet scrunchie?

A single scrunchie uses about 10-15 yards of worsted-weight yarn, so a full skein makes several scrunchies with plenty to spare.

Can I make a crochet scrunchie without an elastic hair tie?

Yes, a length of elastic cord tied into a loop works as a substitute, though a pre-made hair elastic is usually easier to work with and holds its shape longer.

Written by Emily Hartwell

Emily has been crocheting for over a decade, ever since her grandmother taught her the basics one summer. She started CrochetGuides to write the clear, honest, beginner-friendly instructions she wishes she'd had when she was learning — the ones that actually work the first time.